

Website Design System Reference

The canonical style guide for the Hostopia website.
All pages must conform to these specifications.

PREPARED FOR

Hostopia Marketing & Development Teams

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VERSION

1.0 — Extracted from Homepage

HOSTOPIA

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SECTION 1

CSS Custom Properties (Root Variables)

These six CSS custom properties form the foundation of the entire color system. They **MUST** be used everywhere. Never hard-code hex values outside of this palette.

```
:root {  
  --charcoal: #24282b; /* Primary text, dark backgrounds */  
  --teal: #2cadb2; /* Accent, highlights, links */  
  --teal-dark: #1d8f93; /* Hover state for teal */  
  --gold: #f8cf41; /* CTA banner background */  
  --gold-dark: #e0b82a; /* Hover state for gold */  
  --cream: #f7f6f2; /* Alternating section background */  
}
```

SECTION 2

Color Palette & Usage Rules

Primary Colors

Token	Hex	RGB	Usage
Charcoal	#24282b	rgb(36, 40, 43)	Primary text, dark section backgrounds, footer
Teal	#2cadb2	rgb(44, 173, 178)	Accent highlights, stat numbers, eyebrow labels, links
Teal Dark	#1d8f93	--	Hover state for teal buttons/links
Gold	#f8cf41	rgb(248, 207, 65)	CTA banner background, decorative accents
Gold Dark	#e0b82a	--	Hover state for gold elements
Cream	#f7f6f2	rgb(247, 246, 242)	Alternating section background (light sections)

Neutral Colors

Color	Value	Usage
White	#ffffff	Alternating section bg, card backgrounds, stat box backgrounds
Gray 50	#f9fafb	FAQ / light section background variant
Gray 200	#e5e7eb	Stat grid gap / divider color
Gray Text	#888888	Stat box labels
Sub-copy Gray	#6b7280	Body / paragraph text (text-gray-500)
Dark Sub-copy	#4a4e52	Paragraph text on gold backgrounds

Section Background Alternation Pattern

The homepage alternates section backgrounds in a strict rhythm. Follow this pattern for all pages:

#	Background	Section
1	Cream (#f7f6f2)	Hero section

#	Background	Section
2	White	Why Partners Choose Hostopia
3	Cream	Built For rotating section
4	White	Product / services grid
5	Charcoal (#24282b)	Migration / dark accent section
6	White	Support section
7	Cream	Testimonials / social proof
8	White	Integration partners
9	Gold (#f8cf41)	Final CTA banner
10	Gray 50 (#f9fafb)	FAQ

Rule: Never place two consecutive sections with the same background color.

SECTION 3

Typography System

Font Families

Font	Usage	Import
Montserrat	Headings (H1, H2, H3), stat numbers, feature card numbers	Google Fonts
Raleway	Navigation, body text, buttons, paragraphs, all non-heading text	Google Fonts

Rule: Headings always use Montserrat. Body and UI text always use Raleway. Never mix.

Heading Styles

Element	Size	Weight	Line Height	Letter Spacing	Color
H1 (Hero)	72px	900 (black)	1.02	-1.8px (tight)	Charcoal #24282b
H2 (Section)	72px	900 (black)	1.25 (tight)	normal	Charcoal #24282b
H2 (Gold banner)	88px	900 (black)	tight	normal	Charcoal #24282b
H3 (Card title)	24px	900 (black)	default	normal	Charcoal #24282b
H3 (Service card)	20px	900 (black)	default	normal	Charcoal #24282b

Heading Color Accent Pattern

Headings frequently contain **one or two key words highlighted in teal** to draw attention. This is the signature Hostopia heading style.

Example: "Behind the **Brands** That **Power** Small Business"

Rule: Every H1 and H2 should have 1-2 strategically chosen words in teal (#2cadb2). The highlighted words should represent the key value concept of that section.

Body Text Styles

Context	Size	Weight	Line Height	Color	Max Width
Hero sub-copy	20px	400	28px	#6b7280 (gray-500)	36rem (max-w-xl)
Section description	18px	400	28px	#6b7280 (gray-500)	--
Feature card body	14px	400	relaxed	#6b7280 (gray-500)	--
Stat box label	12px	600	normal	#888888	--
Gold section body	18px	400	28px	#4a4e52	--

Eyebrow / Section Label

Every section uses a consistent **.section-label** pattern above its heading:

Property	Value
Font Size	11.2px (~0.7rem)
Font Weight	700 (bold)
Letter Spacing	2.24px (~0.14em)
Text Transform	uppercase
Color	Teal #2cadb2
Font Family	Raleway
Margin Bottom	16px (mb-4)

Rule: Every section **MUST** have an eyebrow label above its H2 heading.

SECTION 4

Layout & Spacing

Container

Property	Value	Tailwind Class
Max width	80rem (1280px)	max-w-7xl
Horizontal padding	24px	px-6
Centering	Auto margins	mx-auto

Standard container pattern: max-w-7xl mx-auto px-6

Section Padding

Property	Value	Tailwind Class
Vertical padding (standard)	112px top and bottom	py-28
Hero section	80px top (accounts for fixed nav)	pt-20 + min-h-screen

Rule: All content sections use py-28 (112px vertical padding). Non-negotiable.

Content Max Widths

Context	Max Width	Tailwind Class
Main container	80rem / 1280px	max-w-7xl
Hero sub-copy	36rem / 576px	max-w-xl
Section descriptions	48rem / 768px	max-w-4xl (centered)
Narrow content blocks	32rem / 512px	max-w-lg

SECTION 5

Component Patterns

5a. Stat / Proof Point Boxes

The stats bar shows key metrics (500+, 99.99%, 20M+, 24/7) in a 4-column grid with 1px dividers.

Container Properties:

Property	Value
Grid	grid-cols-2 md:grid-cols-4
Gap	1px (gap-px) -- creates thin divider lines
Container background	bg-gray-200 (the divider color shows through gaps)
Border radius	16px (rounded-2xl)
Overflow	hidden (clips children to rounded corners)
Shadow	shadow-sm

Individual Stat Item:

Element	Property	Value
Container	Padding	32px (p-8)
Container	Background	White, hover: bg-gray-50
Number	Font size	36px (text-4xl)
Number	Font weight	900 (font-black)
Number	Color	Teal #2cadb2
Number	Font	Montserrat
Label	Font size	12px (text-xs)
Label	Font weight	600 (font-semibold)
Label	Transform	uppercase
Label	Tracking	tracking-wider (0.6px)

Element	Property	Value
Label	Color	#888888

5b. Numbered Feature Cards (Why Hostopia)

Four-column grid with large decorative numbers, a teal accent bar, and text content.

Element	Property	Value
Card	Padding	40px (p-10)
Card	Background	White, hover: bg-gray-50
Card	Transition	transition-colors duration-300
Decorative Number	Font size	96px (text-8xl)
Decorative Number	Font weight	900 (font-black)
Decorative Number	Color	rgb(243, 244, 246) -- very faint (text-gray-100)
Decorative Number	Font	Montserrat
Teal Accent Bar	Width	48px (w-12)
Teal Accent Bar	Height	4px (h-1)
Teal Accent Bar	Color	Teal #2cadb2 (bg-teal)
Title (H3)	Font size	24px (text-2xl), weight 900
Body (P)	Color	text-gray-500, leading-relaxed (1.625)

5c. Service / Product Cards

Full-width horizontal cards using a 12-column grid layout.

Property	Value
Layout	grid md:grid-cols-12
Background	White, hover: bg-gray-50
Transition	transition-colors duration-300
Title font size	20px (text-xl), weight 900 (font-black)

Property	Value
Body font size	14px (text-sm), leading-relaxed

5d. Dark Section (Charcoal Background)

Used for high-impact sections like Migrations. Creates strong visual contrast.

Element	Property	Value
Section	Background	Charcoal #24282b
Heading	Color	White #ffffff
Accent words	Color	Teal #2cadb2
Body text	Color	rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.7) -- 70% white
Eyebrow label	Color	Teal #2cadb2 (same as light sections)

5e. Gold CTA Banner Section

The high-visibility call-to-action section near the bottom of the page.

Element	Value
Background	Gold #f8cf41
H2 font size	88px (larger than standard H2)
H2 color	Charcoal #24282b
Accent words	White #ffffff (inverted from the usual teal)
Body text	#4a4e52
CTA link	Teal #2cadb2

5f. Navigation Bar

Property	Value
Position	Fixed, top: 0, z-index: 50
Background	rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.95) -- 95% white
Transition	transition-all duration-300
Nav link font	Raleway, 14px, weight 500
Nav link color	Charcoal #24282b, hover: Teal

5g. Footer

Property	Value
Background	Charcoal #24282b
Text color	White / light gray variants

SECTION 6

Buttons & CTAs

Primary Button (Teal)

Property	Value
Background	Teal #2cadb2
Hover background	Teal Dark #1d8f93
Text color	White
Padding	16px 32px (py-4 px-8)
Border radius	9999px (rounded-full) -- pill shape
Font weight	600 (font-semibold)
Font size	14px (text-sm)
Letter spacing	0.6px (tracking-wide)
Text transform	uppercase
Transition	transition-colors duration-200

Secondary Button (Charcoal)

Same properties as Primary, except background is Charcoal #24282b with hover bg-gray-800.

Ghost / Outline Button

2px white border, white text. On hover: white background with charcoal text. All other properties (pill shape, uppercase, tracking) match primary.

Rule: All buttons use rounded-full (pill shape). Never use squared or slightly-rounded buttons.

SECTION 7

Animations & Transitions

Standard Transitions

Context	Duration	Easing	Classes
Navigation	300ms	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)	transition-all duration-300
Button hover	200ms	default ease	transition-colors duration-200
Card hover	300ms	default ease	transition-colors duration-300
Stat box hover	200ms	default ease	transition-colors duration-200

Scroll / Reveal Animations

The homepage uses scroll-triggered fade-in animations. Elements enter with:

Property	From	To
Opacity	0	1
Transform	translateY(20px)	translateY(0)
Duration	--	600ms
Easing	--	ease-out

Rule: All sections should animate in on scroll. Stagger child elements by 100-150ms.

Hover Effects

Component	Hover Effect
Feature cards	Background: white -> gray-50
Stat boxes	Background: white -> gray-50
Service cards	Background: white -> gray-50
Buttons	Background color shift (teal -> teal-dark)

Component	Hover Effect
Nav links	Text color: charcoal -> teal

SECTION 8

Shadows & Border Radius

Shadows

Token	Value	Usage
shadow-sm	0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,0.05)	Stat boxes container

The homepage uses shadows very sparingly. Most elevation is communicated through background color differences and the gap-px divider technique.

Border Radius Tokens

Token	Value	Usage
rounded-2xl	16px	Stat box container, card containers
rounded-full	9999px	All buttons (pill shape)
rounded	4px	Nav items

SECTION 9

"Built For" Rotating Section Pattern

This section showcases different partner types with a rotating headline. The teal-colored word rotates between: ISPs, Telcos, Cablecos, Distributors, Resellers, MSPs.

Structure:

Element	Specification
Section background	Cream #f7f6f2
Eyebrow	.section-label: 'Built for Service Providers Who Sell to Small Business'
H2	font-black text-7xl leading-tight
H2 pattern	'Built for [TEAL WORD]' -- rotating partner type in teal
Sub-copy	text-xl text-gray-500 max-w-xl
Padding	py-28 (112px)

SECTION 10

Consistency Checklist for New Pages

When building or auditing any page, verify every item below:

1. **Fonts:** Headings use Montserrat (weight 900). Body uses Raleway (weight 400-500).
2. **Colors:** Only use the 6 defined palette colors + neutral grays. No rogue hex values.
3. **Section padding:** All sections use py-28 (112px).
4. **Container:** All content wrapped in max-w-7xl mx-auto px-6.
5. **Background alternation:** Sections alternate cream/white. Never two same-color in a row.
6. **Eyebrow labels:** Every section has a teal uppercase label above its heading.
7. **Heading accents:** H1 and H2 headings include 1-2 words in teal.
8. **Buttons:** Always pill-shaped (rounded-full), uppercase, text-sm, tracking-wide.
9. **Hover states:** Cards use hover:bg-gray-50. Buttons shift color. Links go teal.
10. **Animations:** Sections fade-up on scroll. Transitions use 200-300ms durations.
11. **Stat boxes:** Use the gap-px bg-gray-200 rounded-2xl divider grid pattern.
12. **Feature cards:** Include decorative large faint numbers + teal accent bar.
13. **Dark sections:** White text, teal accents, 70% opacity body text.
14. **Shadows:** Minimal -- only shadow-sm on containers, not individual cards.

SECTION 11

Tailwind Custom Config Requirements

Ensure `tailwind.config.js` includes these custom extensions:

```
module.exports = {
  theme: {
    extend: {
      colors: {
        charcoal: '#24282b',
        teal: '#2cadb2',
        'teal-dark': '#1d8f93',
        gold: '#f8cf41',
        'gold-dark': '#e0b82a',
        cream: '#f7f6f2',
      },
      fontFamily: {
        montserrat: ['Montserrat', 'sans-serif'],
        raleway: ['Raleway', 'sans-serif'],
      },
    },
  },
}
```

Document generated March 2026. Based on analysis of the Hostopia homepage. This is a living document -- update as the design system evolves.